Quick Start

Council of War · how to play in five minutes

Everything you need for your first few battles. The game explains the rest as it comes up, and you can press and hold anything to read exactly what it does.

1 The goal

Win a campaign of **30 battles**. Each battle has a **target score**; reach it to win. Targets start low (40 in battle 1) and climb as your army grows.

Lose a battle and you **retry it**: same board, freshly shuffled deck. Nothing is lost; a retried win just earns half the Laurels (your run score). After every two failed retries you get a fresh set of generals.

2 A battle in 30 seconds

1. The board is a **4×4 grid of terrain**: forest, hills, plains and fields.
2. You get **8 turns**. Each turn, **3 cards** are dealt from your deck.
3. **Pick one and place it** on an empty tile: tap the card then a lit tile, or drag it. The other two go to the bottom of the deck.
4. After 8 placements the board scores. Beat the target and you win.

8 cards on 16 tiles: half the board stays empty, so *where* you put things matters as much as what you pick.

> **Tip** · Made a mistake? **Undo** (bottom-left) takes back placements. Use it freely to try ideas.

3 How units score

Your deck starts as 30 plain soldiers: 10 each of **Infantry** **Archers** **Cavalry**. Each placed unit scores its **power**, then multipliers stack on top.

Thing	Effect
Rank	Base power: rank 1 = **2**, rank 2 = **4**, rank 3 = **7**, rank 4 = **12**. Units earn XP from battles they win and rank up.
Home terrain	**×2**
Infantry forest · **Archers** hills · **Cavalry** plains · fields are nobody's home	
Fort	**×3.5 (built by Engineers, from battle 4)**
Formations	A **bonus on top**, but only for formations your generals teach (next section).

> **Tip** · Home terrain is the easiest double there is. When you hold a unit, its home tiles glow.

4 Generals: the heart of the game

You have a pool of **6 generals** (picked at random when you start). Each battle, **3 of them are dealt** and stand above the board. They decide how this battle scores, so **read them before your first placement**.

Two kinds

- **Teachers** (Captains) make one **formation** live for the battle. A formation only scores if a dealt general teaches it.
- **Boosters** buff something: e.g. *Sergeant of Foot* (Infantry +power), *Steward* (home terrain bigger than ×2), *Quartermaster* (units *not* in a formation ×N). Rare ones like *Tactician* multiply the whole battle.

Generals level up when you **promote** them (after boss wins), and you can win new ones in the spoils.

> **Tip** · Press and hold a general to read its exact rule at its current level. **Info** (bottom-right) lists all your generals and every formation with a diagram.

5 Formations

A formation adds a percentage of its members' points. Bigger shapes pay more. Units in a formation still score their own value too, and one unit can be part of several different formations.



Triad
1 of each type, touching · **+60%**



Raiding Party
2 Cavalry + 1 Archers, touching · **+35%**



Shield Wall
3 Infantry in a straight line · **+125%**



Wedge
3 Cavalry in an L · **+65%**



Pincer
Cavalry at both ends of a row/column, units between · **+45%**



Covered Archers
2 Archers + 2 Infantry, touching · **+95%**



Combined Arms
2 of each type filling a 2×3 block, any order · **+135%**



Hammer and Anvil
A Shield Wall + 2 Cavalry touching it · **+130%**



Battle Line
3 Infantry in a line, 3 Archers right beside them · **+280%**

Percentages are at level 1 and still being tuned. "Touching" means up, down, left or right, not diagonal.

> **Tip** · Plan the shape on turn 1. You only get 8 placements, so pick tiles that let a formation land on home terrain too.

6 Between battles

- **Spoils** (after every win): choose 1 of 3 rewards, a new card or occasionally a general. A new card **replaces** one of 3 random cards in your deck, so your deck stays at its size. You can always refuse.
- **Upgrade** (every 3 battles): a trait to give to one of your units, such as *Rally*, *Banner* or *Sure-footed*, or a **kind** like Knights, Pikemen or Longbowmen.
- **Boss battles** (every 5th): a twist such as fog, a blocked tile, a closed row or only 7 turns. Win one and you **promote** one of its generals a level.

Tap **Deck** any time to see every card you own and your generals' pool.

7 New card types (battles 2 to 4)

Each one arrives with its own introduction screen and joins your deck.

Battle	Arrives	What it does
2	**Officers**	Multiply every unit of their type in their shape (shown on the card). Play one on an empty tile to stand alone, or on a unit to command it.
3	**Heroes**	Units that start at rank 2 with a special rule, e.g. *Vanguard* is huge if played in the first two turns.
4	**Engineers**	Build a **fort** on an empty tile (×3.5 for the unit that stands on it). Costs a turn, but the tile stays free.

8 First-run tips

- **Read the 3 dealt generals first.** They tell you which formation to build and which units are worth the most this battle.
- **Home terrain is free points.** A rank-1 unit at home is worth as much as a rank-2 unit anywhere else.
- **Don't chase every formation.** One solid formation on good terrain usually beats two half-built ones.
- **Press and hold** any card, tile, general or formation tag to see exactly what it does.
- **Losing is normal.** Retries are free; experiment with Undo and learn the board.
- Upgrades and kinds go furthest on units you'll keep drawing, so spread them around rather than stacking one card.

9 Controls & setup

Undo
Take back a placement

Deck
Your cards and generals

Info
Formations & generals reference

Menu
Quit the campaign, choose another, reset tips

- Best on an **iPad held upright**. Phones work too, also upright.
- Your progress **saves in this browser** automatically. A different browser or device starts fresh.
- Add the home page to your home screen to play full-screen.

Spotted a bug, a confusing rule, or a battle that felt unwinnable? Note the battle number and what you were trying to do. That's exactly what we need.